

Family Liaison Officer

At Leigh Academies Trust, we understand the vital role strong home-academy partnerships play in a child's education. The Family Liaison Officer is pivotal in fostering these connections, ensuring that every student has the support they need to thrive. This role involves coordinating and managing the crucial link between the academy, families, and external agencies, particularly for our most vulnerable students. You will be a key point of contact, working to break down barriers to education and empower families to support their children's success.

Core Purpose

The core purpose of the Family Liaison Officer is to build and maintain strong, effective relationships between the academy, families, and external agencies. You will work proactively to identify and address the needs of vulnerable students, especially those with persistent absenteeism or those facing disadvantage. By serving as a bridge between home and academy, you will help to create a supportive network that enables students to overcome challenges, engage fully with their education, and achieve their full potential. Your work will contribute to a positive and inclusive learning environment where every student feels valued, supported, and empowered to succeed.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Liaison and Communication

- Act as a primary point of contact for parents, maintaining regular communication regarding academy matters, student progress, and any concerns that may arise.
- Work closely with the Attendance Officer to monitor student attendance, identify patterns of absence, and develop strategies to improve attendance, particularly for persistent absentees.
- Maintain accurate and up-to-date attendance records, working in collaboration with the Attendance Officer and Student Services Managers.
- Communicate effectively with academy staff, ensuring they are fully informed of any family or student issues that may impact a child's learning or well-being.
- Prepare reports and case studies for academy leaders, providing valuable insights into student and family needs.
- Support the Designated Safeguarding Lead in conducting home visits and liaising with families in safeguarding matters, and when children are known to social services.
- Facilitate communication between families and the academy in instances where student behavior has led to suspensions or permanent exclusion, ensuring all parties are informed and supported.

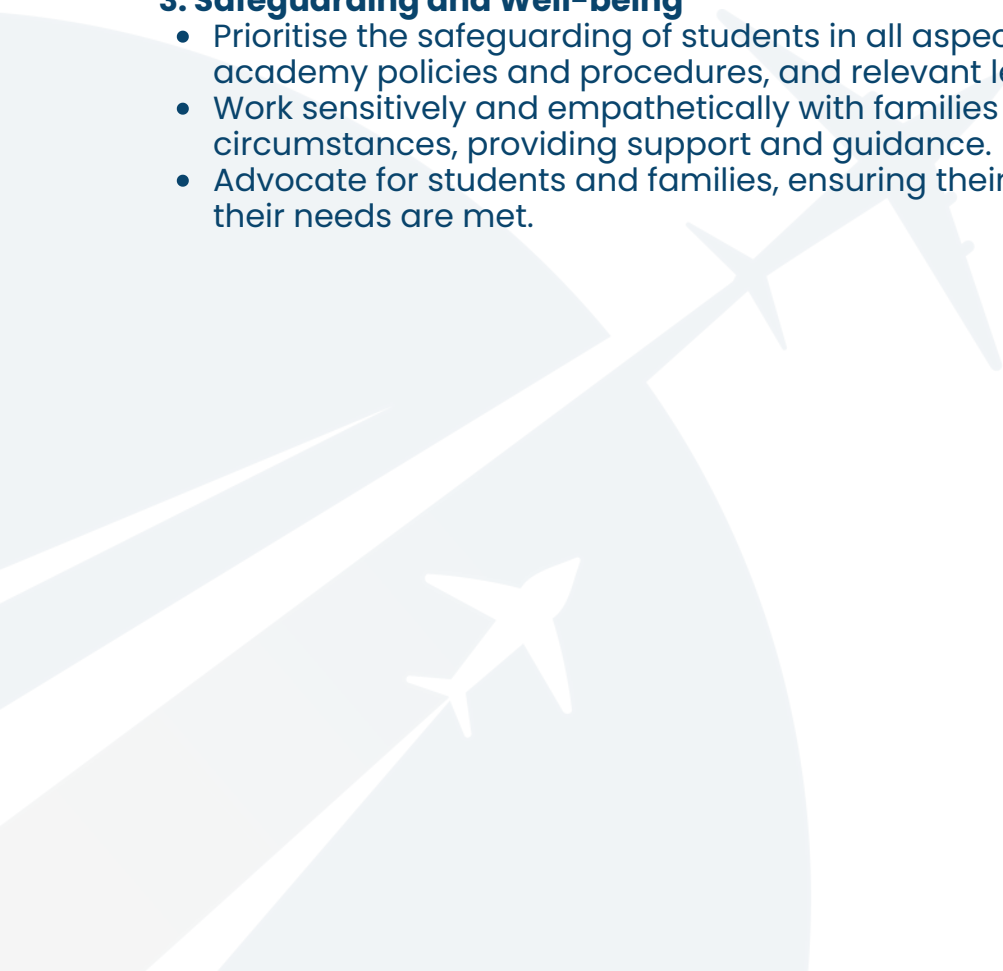
- Support the production of necessary paperwork for governor panels and parents related to fixed-term suspensions and permanent exclusions.
- Work with families and external providers to identify suitable managed move options for students at risk of permanent exclusion.
- Contribute to college administrative tasks, including behavior, attendance, rewards, and personal development, and provide administrative support to the College SLT team and the Attendance Officer as needed.

2. Intervention and Support

- Develop and implement targeted interventions for students and families to address barriers to attendance and improve student outcomes.
- Conduct home visits to engage with parents/carers, understand family circumstances, and provide support in encouraging regular school attendance.
- Support school refusers in reintegrating into the academy environment, collaborating with external agencies as necessary.
- Coordinate appropriate interventions for children and families, based on needs identified during meetings with parents and students.
- Meet with and mentor Pupil Premium students to identify their needs and provide tailored support, both within the academy and at home.
- Support the management of the Pupil Premium budget to ensure resources are effectively allocated to provide necessary support, trips, and resources for Pupil Premium families.
- Participate in Early Intervention meetings and manage referrals as appropriate, working collaboratively with other professionals.

3. Safeguarding and Well-being

- Prioritise the safeguarding of students in all aspects of the role, adhering to academy policies and procedures, and relevant legislation and guidance.
- Work sensitively and empathetically with families facing challenging circumstances, providing support and guidance.
- Advocate for students and families, ensuring their voices are heard and their needs are met.



Person Specification – Family Liaison Officer

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes for the Family Liaison Officer role:

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- Educated to GCSE level standard or equivalent (English and Maths A*-C grade or equivalent).
- Evidence of continuous professional development related to safeguarding children and vulnerable adults.
- Understanding of safeguarding procedures and the ability to identify potential safeguarding concerns.
- Knowledge of relevant legislation and guidance related to safeguarding, child protection, and data protection.

Desirable:

- Additional qualifications in social work, family support, or a related field.
- Training in specific intervention strategies or programs (e.g., motivational interviewing, solution-focused therapy).
- Knowledge of the local community and support services available to families.

Experience

Essential:

- Experience of working with children, young people, and families.
- Experience of communicating effectively with a range of stakeholders, including parents/carers, students, and external agencies.
- Experience of maintaining accurate records and case notes.

Desirable:

- Experience of working in a school or education setting.
- Experience of carrying out home visits.
- Experience of working with Pupil Premium students and addressing barriers to their education.
- Experience in a similar role involving family support or community outreach.
- Experience of working with students with Special Educational Needs and/or Disabilities (SEND).
- Experience in supporting students with social, emotional, and mental health needs.

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- Understanding of the factors that can affect student attendance, behaviour, and engagement in education.
- Knowledge of strategies for working with families to improve student outcomes.

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Desirable:

- Knowledge of the National Curriculum and its implications for student learning.
- Understanding of the challenges faced by families from diverse backgrounds.
- Knowledge of trauma-informed practice.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- Excellent communication and interpersonal skills, with the ability to build rapport and establish trust with families, students, and colleagues.
- Strong organisational and time management skills, with the ability to manage a varied workload, prioritise tasks, and meet deadlines.
- Ability to work independently and as part of a team, collaborating effectively with teachers, support staff, and external agencies.
- Resilience and ability to handle challenging situations with professionalism and composure.
- Ability to maintain confidentiality and handle sensitive information with discretion and integrity.
- A commitment to promoting positive outcomes for students and families.
- Ability to work sensitively and empathetically with families facing challenging circumstances.
- Ability to advocate for students and families, ensuring their needs are understood and addressed.
- Proficiency in literacy, numeracy, and ICT, with the ability to use technology to support communication, record-keeping, and data analysis.

Desirable:

- Ability to adapt communication to suit different audiences, tailoring language and communication style to the age, needs, and abilities of individual students and families.
- Ability to use initiative, proactively identifying and addressing needs within the school and community, and taking responsibility for tasks as appropriate.
- Strong problem-solving skills, with the ability to identify issues, develop solutions, and implement effective strategies.

Personal Qualities

The Family Liaison Officer will be a **highly motivated** and **compassionate** individual with a genuine passion for supporting the well-being and academic success of all students. They will demonstrate a **strong commitment** to building **positive and respectful relationships** with families, colleagues, and external agencies. Possessing **excellent interpersonal skills**, they will **communicate effectively, listen attentively**, and **respond with empathy and understanding**. The Family Liaison Officer will be **proactive, resourceful**, and **dedicated** to finding solutions that address the diverse needs of students and their families. They will be **resilient, adaptable**, and able to **manage challenging situations** with **professionalism** and a **positive attitude**. Furthermore, they will uphold the highest standards of **integrity, confidentiality**, and **ethical conduct**, demonstrating a deep commitment to safeguarding the welfare of every child and promoting a **positive and inclusive school community**.

Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document \(Department of Education\)](#).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.